

Learner-training worksheet 5

Recording and remembering vocabulary

1 DIFFERENT WAYS OF RECORDING VOCABULARY

Look at the following ways that students use for recording new vocabulary and discuss the questions in the box below.

a

divorce rate — *percentuale di divorzi*

get married — *sposarsi*

average — *medio*

career — *carriera*

bother with — *preoccuparsi di*

b



do the housework



chat on the phone



entertain friends

c

A acquaintance

aunt

average

B best friend

birthrate

boss

C career

chat

classmate

d

social

going out

entertaining friends

chatting on the phone

staying in

sport

doing exercise

mountain-climbing

playing squash

work and study

doing a course

studying hard

domestic

doing the housework

cooking

gardening

looking after the children

other

relaxing and doing nothing

e

divorce rate — *divɔ:sreɪt* number of divorces over a certain time

acquaintance — *əkweɪntəns* someone you know, but not a friend

entertain (friends) — *entəteɪn* invite people to your house and give them food and drink

chat — *tʃæt* have a conversation with a friend

Discussion point 1

- Do you have a special notebook for recording new words and phrases?
- Which of the methods above do you use for recording new words and phrases?
- What do you think are the advantages and disadvantages of each one?
- How useful is it to copy out new words and phrases into your vocabulary notebook after the lesson?

2 DIFFERENT WAYS OF REMEMBERING VOCABULARY

a) Here are some different methods language students sometimes use for remembering new words and phrases. Read them, and then answer the questions in the box below.

- repeating the new words over and over again to yourself
- writing new words out three or four times
- inventing sentences / short dialogues in your head, using the new words
- testing yourself by covering up the words and using the definitions / translations to remind you of the word
- using cards with the new word on one side and the meaning on the other to test yourself
- making lists of related new words (for example, 'family vocabulary') and sticking it up on the wall in your house
- reading through your vocabulary notes for ten minutes every day
- selecting the new words that you personally find useful and only trying to learn these

Discussion point 2

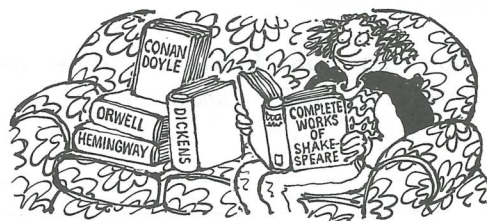
- Have you ever tried any of these methods?
- Do you have any other methods for learning vocabulary not included on the list?
- Do you have any suggestions for your teacher about how he / she could help you to remember vocabulary (for example, by giving you vocabulary tests)?

b) Choose one of the methods of study listed above and try it out for the next week or two. Report back to the class on how useful you found it.

3 EXTENDING YOUR VOCABULARY BY YOURSELF

Here are some different ways that you can improve your vocabulary by yourself. Read them, and then answer the questions in the box below.

- reading books in English, including graded readers (such as the *Penguin-Longman Readers*)
- reading an English-language newspaper or magazine
- watching English-language films with subtitles
- finding out the words to English-language songs
- watching an English-language cable TV channel
- listening to the radio in English (the BBC world service or local English-language radio programmes)
- getting an English penfriend

*Discussion point 3*

- Do you do any of these things already? How useful do you find them for improving your vocabulary?
- Do you have time to start doing any of these things? If so, which appeals to you most?
- If you do these things, how important do you think it is that you understand and study every new word that you meet?
- Can you tell the other students about any places or facilities that might be useful in your area (for example, a cinema that shows subtitled films, or a library that has English-language magazines)?